CLAIMS

What is claimed is:

1. A system for automated data logistics, comprising:

- a portable data cartridge having a massively parallel optical interface; and
- an autonomous robotic unit comprising a manipulator configured to physically grasp, transport, and release the data cartridge.

2. The system of claim 1, wherein the robotic unit is an unmanned aerial vehicle (drone).

3. The system of claim 1, wherein the robotic unit is a robotic arm installed within a data center.

4. The system of claim 1, wherein the robotic unit is further configured to dock with a data port and facilitate the transfer of data to or from the data cartridge via the optical interface.

5. A method for physically transporting data, comprising the steps of:

- dispatching an autonomous robotic unit to a first location having a data port containing a portable optical data cartridge;
- causing the robotic unit to use a manipulator to retrieve the data cartridge from the port;
- transporting, by the robotic unit, the data cartridge to a second location; and
- causing the robotic unit to deposit the data cartridge at the second location.